'Success depends upon previous preparation, and without such preparation there is sure to be failure.'

Confucius

Student Handbook

English for Academic Purposes: Masters Module

CNEAP 402 (Semester 2, 2026)

Lancaster University College
at Beijing Jiaotong University

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OVERALL AIMS OF MODULE

The Masters's programme has been designed to widen the scope of your language-related academic skills required for successful study at Higher Education level. These are needed in approaches to academic research, the processes and conventions of academic writing, effective reading strategies, participation in seminars and the successful delivery of presentations, as well as recording information accurately from lectures. During the course, the range and accuracy of your written and spoken academic English language will be further extended, to help you develop competence and confidence in a variety of academic contexts. Particular support will be offered to promote personal reflection on your learning and critical thinking to facilitate deeper insights and new perspectives.

On completion of the module, you will be better able to:

- Read with a large degree of independence, using effective reading strategies to identify the main lines of argument in academic texts and find specific information.
- Express opinions clearly, in spoken form, using a range of language and complex sentence forms, with appropriate style and register, whilst supporting those opinions with relevant sources of information
- Follow and take effective notes on the essentials of lectures, talks, reports and other forms of academic/professional presentations, which are propositionally and linguistically complex
- Write an essay systematically developing an argument with appropriate highlighting of significant points and relevant supporting information, and synthesizing information and arguments from several relevant sources
- Understand the value of autonomy, reflective learning and ethical academic practices

Specific Learning outcomes (Semester 2)

On completion of Semester 2, you will be better able to:

- Research written tasks effectively, identifying and incorporating reliable and relevant source materials
- Understand in detail complex texts likely to be encountered in academic life
- Read with a large degree of independence, using effective reading strategies to identify arguments.
- Evaluate the reliability of sources and evaluate the strength of claims
- Deduce meaning and use strategies for understanding the meaning of unknown words, understanding implied meaning and author intent
- Understand the structure and language for a research proposal containing a literature review

- Deliver a well-structured, detailed poster presentation to an audience and respond to questions
- Use strategies to aid meaning and maintain interest such as pronunciation, non-verbal communication and audio / visual aids

- Use targeted grammatical features, demonstrating an acceptable level of accuracy in spoken communication
- Maintain a reasonable degree of fluency (rhythm and pace) in speech with few hesitations and/or repetition
- Give a clear, well-structured presentation on a complex subject, expanding and supporting points of view

- Manipulate rhetorical functions to suit a clear communicative purpose, with a wide lexical resource
- Write linguistically complex texts, synthesizing and evaluating information
- Maintain a high degree of grammatical control in writing and speech with appropriate style and register
- Employ wide range of vocabulary with sufficient accuracy to convey precise meaning
- Follow subject-specific academic conventions in written tasks, through referencing and meeting task requirements

- Recognise structure in lectures or discussions through the use of discourse markers and rhetorical function
- Follow discussions between speakers on a variety of academic and social topics
- Follow and take detailed notes from texts, lectures, and presentations with relative ease
- Use abbreviations and symbols in note-taking consistently and accurately
- Take and organize notes of longer-length authentic academic lectures and informal listening passages using a variety of appropriate outlining techniques

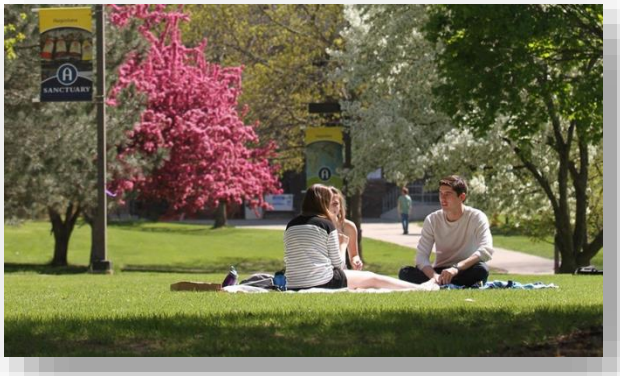
- Develop and engage with reflective learning and critical thinking processes
- Demonstrate competence in strategies to avoid plagiarism, collusion and the embellishment of data
- Elaborate on arguments with relevant supporting evidence and criticize others' views effectively
- Participate in active dialogue with a text, by posing questions, making inferences, examining an author's reasoning and drawing associations
- Engage in evaluation through multiple-drafting and dialogic peer-learning

CLASSES AND USING MOODLE

Your EAP 402 lessons will be taught in-class throughout the semester. However, your learning will often be asynchronous - you will study by yourself referring to the course materials uploaded to an online platform called Moodle). The majority of your learning will consist of self-guided independent study, which is normal at university. We will make considerable use of online resources though the learning platform, Moodle and communications will occur via Email, Moodle and WeChat. If you wish to refresh your memory about how to access Moodle, please watch the video in this ***link***. Remember that for Lancaster University College at Beijing Jiaotong University students the web address is ***modules.lucbjtu.ac.uk***

EAP 402 MOODLE PAGE

The EAP 402 Moodle page will be central to your academic English studies at Lancaster University College at BJTU, as all the learning materials will be placed there, and we will refer to Moodle in almost every class. Currently, there are several sections giving important information on all areas of EAP, and more folders/documents/links will be added as we progress in Semester 2.



The main headings and features of EAP 402 are shown below:

CN EAP 402 English for Academic Purposes Master's Module

Welcome to EAP 402. This page will provide information and learning materials for our course. Feel free to contact me by email: m.warrick@lancaster.ac.uk

Important documents: This first section contains the schedule for Semester 2, task/cover sheets required for submissions and the descriptors used to evaluate your work.

- Assessments Schedule
- Writing Coursework Assignment Task Sheet
- Coursework Essay Cover Sheet
- Poster Presentation Task Sheet

Independent Research Portfolio

This section provides the Independent Research Portfolio Guide and two essential booklets in which you should complete all your IRP assignments:

- Independent Research Portfolio Guide
- Self-Evaluation and Learning Log Booklet
- Lesson Tasks Booklet
- Research Proposal Task Sheet
- Research Proposal Booklet

***Resources for Research and Independent Learning**

Here you will find useful documents to support your independent study and research. Discover how to access academic journals in the LU Library, improve your language skills by exploring the online independent study resources and become more effective MS Teams users:

- Introduction to Lancaster Library Resources
- Library Resources guide for students at Weihai
- LU Digital skills Microsoft Teams training
- Independent Research Resources
- EAS: English for Academic Study

***Features of Academic Writing**

In this section you will find PPTs, documents and links to better inform you of all areas of academic English, with a focus on academic writing and vocabulary.

- Academic Vocabulary in Use
- Academic Collocations List (Pearson)
- Oxford Collocations Dictionary for Students of English
- Academic Writing: A Handbook for International Students (Bailey)
- Features of Academic Writing (PowerPoint Presentation)
- UEfAP - Features of Academic Writing
- Academic Phrasebank - General Language Functions

***Referencing and Avoiding Plagiarism**

This section gives links and documents that will enable you to reference your work using the Harvard System of Referencing.

- Reference Lists and In-text Citations
- LU Library Harvard Referencing Guide
- Cite Them Right

Listening Practice Resources

Here are some links to different websites which you can enjoy and find useful to help develop your listening skills.

- BBC Six Minute English
- EAP Foundation Podcasts are audios that are 5 - 7 minutes in length and mostly focus on academic study skills advice
- British Council > Learn English > Skills > Listening
- Cambridge Assessment > Learning English > Listening

Upload Area for students (Assessed Work)

You should upload all assessed or non-assessed work here, when requested to do so.

Weekly Materials for Students

This area offers learning materials in weekly folders: Weeks 1-12

EAP 402 – ASSESSMENT SCHEDULE

WEEK #	w/c	Independent Research Portfolio (25%)				COURSEWORK ESSAY 30% & PRESENTATION (15%)
		Class Topic	**Lesson Tasks (LT)**	**SELF-EVALUATION AND LEARNING LOG**	**RESEARCH PROPOSAL**	
1	2-Mar-26	Review of EAP402 Student Handbook		*Self-evaluation*		*Review task sheet for coursework essay*
2	9-Mar-26	As instructed	*Lesson Task 1*	*Reflection 1*		
3	16-Mar-26	As instructed				
4	23-Mar-26	As instructed	*Lesson Task 2*	*Reflection 2*		
5	30-Mar-26	As instructed				
6	6-Apr-26	As instructed	*Lesson Task 3*	*Reflection 3*		*Peer-review of draft coursework essay* *Submit draft coursework essay*
7	13-Apr-26	As instructed				
8	20-Apr-26	As instructed	*Lesson Task 4*	*Reflection 4*	*Review Task Sheet for EAP 402 IRP Research Proposal* *Review IRP: Research Proposal Booklet'* *Review Task Sheet for EAP 402 Poster Presentation*	*Feedback on Coursework Essay and final review in class* *Submit finalized coursework essay*
9	27-Apr-26	**PRACTICE EXAMS** **Reading** **Listening**				
10	4-May-26	As instructed	*Lesson Task 5*	*Reflection 5*	*RP1: Introduction and Literature Review*	*Peer review of Introduction and*

					Literature Review of Research Proposal *Submit finalized Lesson Tasks Booklet*
11	11-May-26	As instructed		*RP2: Methodology*	
12	18-May-26	As instructed	*Reflection 6*	*RP3: Complete Research Proposal, including conclusion and implications*	*Peer review of Methodology / Conclusion and implications of Research Proposal*
13	25-May-26	**WRITING WEEK**			*Submit finalized IRP Self-Evaluation and Learning Log Booklet*
14	1-June-26	**WRITING WORKSHOP**			*Submit finalized Research Proposal* *Submit draft PowerPoint poster presentation*
15	8-June-26	**WRITING WORKSHOP**			*General feedback on Poster Presentation* *Submit finalized Poster Presentation*
16	15-June-26	***INDIVIDUAL POSTER PRESENTATIONS***			
17	22-June-26	***EXAM WEEK: Reading & Listening (15% + 15%)***			
18	29-Jun-26				

Additional Notes:

*****w/c = week commencing (date weeks begins).*
** IRP submissions will generally be due on the Monday of the following week*

ASSESSMENT GRID

Key:

Coursework 55%	Exams 45%

EAP402 Semester Two (60% weighting of overall module mark)

Item	Activity	Description	Timing	Formative/ Summative	Weighting	Map to Outcomes
1	Essay	Coursework - Cause and Effect Essay (dependent on the masters degree on which the student is enrolled) – 2,500-word project report/essay	Weeks 1-6	Formative/ Summative	30%	Academic Writing: Be able to analyse, evaluate information, plan, draft and organise essays/reports in English, including referencing
2	Independent Research Portfolio	Coursework - Independent Research Portfolio (including a literature review and research proposal)	Weeks 1-12	Formative/ Summative	25%	Academic & Research Skills: Be able to manage own time effectively, to plan own learning strategies, and to be reflective, critical thinkers
3	Reading	Exam - Reading exam including assessment of referencing/citation skills	Exam Week	Summative	15%	Academic Reading: Be able to read effectively, in English, evaluate texts, understand implied meaning, identify key information, and use texts to support arguments
4	Listening	Exam - Listening exam with evaluative summary of lecture	Exam Week	Summative	15%	Academic Listening: Be able to extract main ideas from the lectures given in English, identify speakers' stance, understand meaning and take notes to support academic work
5	Presentation	Exam - Academic Poster Presentation based on Research Proposal	Week 16	Formative/ Summative	15%	Academic Speaking: Be confident speakers of English in seminar situations, give presentations and support arguments

CNEAP 402 COURSEWORK ESSAY TASK SHEET, Semester 2, 2026

ELECTRONIC AND COMMUNICATIONS ENGINEERING GRP

Coursework Essay Title: *Analyse the role of IoT-enabled smart homes in China and evaluate their contribution to enhancing the quality of life of ageing populations.*

Assigned: ***Week 1***

Essay Type: *Cause-Effect Academic Essay*

Weight: 30% *of your final CNEAP402 grade*

COURSEWORK OVERVIEW

This assignment requires you to write a cause-effect academic essay, using real-world examples drawn from Electronic and Communications Engineering. It aims to help you further develop your academic writing skills while evaluating your ability to think critically in relation to IoT-enabled smart homes in China and wellbeing in later life.

HOW YOUR ESSAY WILL BE ASSESSED

This assignment will be assessed by the convenor of CNEAP402 according to the criteria listed below:

1. **Academic Content and Subject Knowledge** *This includes your ability to demonstrate:*

   - Clear understanding and accurate application of key concepts around IoT-enabled smart homes in China
   - Depth of analysis and critical thinking
   - Relevance and clarity of examples and evidence
   - Accurate use of source material to support claims

2. **Academic English and Communication Skills** *This includes your ability to:*

   - Express ideas clearly, fluently, and accurately in written English
   - Use appropriate academic tone and subject-specific vocabulary
   - Structure your essay with a clear introduction, main body, and conclusion
   - Organise ideas into logically developed paragraphs with clear topic sentences
   - Use effective summarising and paraphrasing techniques
   - Maintain cohesion and logical flow throughout the essay
   - Cite and reference sources correctly using Lancaster Harvard style

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF **The coursework essay will address the following task:**

Task Instructions

This essay examines the drivers behind the development of IoT-enabled smart homes in China and evaluates their impact on vulnerable user groups. You are expected to demonstrate conceptual clarity and critical evaluation within a focused discussion. Your essay should be structured to cover:

1. **Extended Definition**: The first paragraph must consist entirely of an extended definition of "IoT-enabled smart homes." Your definition should:
   a) Define IoT in technical terms.
   b) Identify the main components and functions of IoT-enabled smart homes.
   c) Distinguish them from conventional housing.

2. **Drivers of Adoption in China:** Identify and explain key motivations for adopting IoT-enabled smart homes in China. You should focus on two or three key drivers rather than attempting to cover all possible factors. You may consider:
   - Demographic ageing
   - Healthcare pressures
   - National digital or smart city policies
   - Technological and industrial innovation

3. **Impact on Ageing Populations:** Evaluate how IoT-enabled smart homes influence the quality of life of elderly residents in China. Your discussion should prioritise depth of analysis by examining two or three key impacts in detail, rather than attempting to cover all possible outcomes. You may consider:
   - Independence and ageing in place
   - Safety and health monitoring
   - Caregiver burden
   - Social inclusion

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

The use of generative AI tools (for example ChatGPT, Grammarly Premium, or similar software) for drafting, editing, paraphrasing, idea generation, or translation is strictly prohibited.

Use of such tools will be treated as a breach of Lancaster University's academic integrity policy.

You must sign the declaration on the cover page to confirm compliance.

GENERAL GUIDELINES

Formatting Requirements

- You must incorporate the EAP402 Coursework Essay Cover Page at the beginning of your essay (see page 4)
- The essay should be between **900 and 1,200 words** in length (excluding any figures or tables).
- Insert page numbers at the bottom of each page.
- You should use Times New Roman or Arial font in either 11-point or 12-point size.
- Use 1.5 or double line spacing.
- The essay must be written in continuous academic prose without subheadings or bullet points.

Figures and Tables

- The inclusion of figures and/or tables is optional for this essay.
- Each figure and table should be clearly numbered and titled and must be explicitly mentioned within the paragraph (i.e. not just appear).
- Do not reproduce any figures or tables; only use them if you have adapted them and synthesised different elements.

Citation and Referencing

- Use Lancaster University Harvard referencing system as detailed on the CNEAP402 Moodle page.
- Every citation must have a corresponding reference and vice versa.
- Use summarising and paraphrasing effectively. Direct quotations should not exceed 10% of the total word count.
- You must cite a minimum of 5 high-quality academic sources in English, of which at least 3 should be peer-reviewed journal articles.

You must annotate three of your academic sources. For each selected source:

- Highlight or underline key points
- Write brief notes in the margins
- Include the annotated pages at the end of your submission

These annotated pages are not included in the word count.

Do Not (×)

- Use any bullet points
- Write paragraphs that are underdeveloped. A paragraph generally consists of 5–8 sentences that explore a topic with supporting evidence.
- Submit a report. This task must be written as a properly structured academic essay

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Draft Submission: Week 6 (by 23:59 on the date to be confirmed)
- Submit your essay as a Word document via the EAP 402 Moodle page. Submissions cannot be accepted via WeChat or email, and PDF files are not allowed.
- Final submission: Week 8 (by 23:59 on the date to be confirmed). The name of your file should be: 'Coursework Essay Final' - *your student number* - *your name in Pinyin*'
- Your submission must have the EAP402 Coursework Essay Cover Page at the beginning of your document, showing your Chinese name, English name, student number, class number, date and declaration.

Late submission penalties:

- 5% deduction: More than 24 hours late
- 10% deduction: More than 36 hours late

  Note: Only medical exemptions with a valid doctor's note will be accepted.

CNEAP402: Coursework Essay Cover Page

Programme:	English for Academic Purposes – Master's Programme
Module:	EAP 402
Chinese Name:	
English Name:	
Student Number:	
Class:	
Essay Title:	
Word Count	
Date of Submission	

Declaration of Academic Integrity

I declare that this essay is entirely my own work and has been produced without the assistance of generative AI tools (including but not limited to ChatGPT, Grammarly Premium, or similar). I understand that the use of such tools violates Lancaster University's academic integrity policy and may result in academic penalties.

Signed: ……

Date: …….

CNEAP 402 COURSEWORK ESSAY TASK SHEET, Semester 2, 2026

LOGISTICS AND SUPPLY CHAIN MANAGEMENT GRP

Essay Title: *Analyse the Key Drivers and Strategic Implications of SME Supplier Development in Modern Supply Chains*

Assigned: ***Week 1***

Essay Type: *Cause-Effect Academic Essay*

Weight:

- **15%** of your final CNMSCI573 (Operations and Supply Chain Excellence) grade
- **30%** of your final CNEAP402 grade

COURSEWORK OVERVIEW

This coursework requires a cause–effect academic essay that critically examines the drivers of SME supplier development and evaluates their strategic implications for supply chain management. Students must demonstrate the ability to analyse causal relationships and synthesise academic research with real-world examples.

HOW YOUR ESSAY WILL BE ASSESSED

This assignment will be evaluated by the convenor of CNEAP402 according to the criteria listed below:

3. **Academic Content and Subject Knowledge** *This includes your ability to demonstrate:*

- Clear understanding and accurate application of key concepts related to SME supplier development and supply chain strategy
- Integration and synthesis of relevant academic literature
- Clear cause–effect reasoning linking drivers to strategic implications
- Depth of critical analysis beyond descriptive explanation
- Effective use of real-world examples to support and illustrate arguments

4. **Academic English and Communication Skills** *This includes your ability to:*

- Present ideas clearly, accurately, and in an appropriate academic register
- Structure the essay logically with a coherent introduction, developed body paragraphs, and a focused conclusion
- Construct well-developed paragraphs with clear topic sentences and evidence-based argumentation
- Use summarising and paraphrasing appropriately
- Maintain cohesion and logical progression throughout
- Apply Lancaster Harvard referencing accurately and consistently

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF

This essay focuses on the causes (drivers) of supplier development, and should be structured to cover:

a) Extended Definition: The first body paragraph must be comprised of a clear, extended definition of SME supplier development within the context of global logistics and supply chain management.

b) The Drivers: Identify and explain the primary factors forcing changes in this area. You should synthesize research on key drivers such as digital transformation, cost efficiency strategies, sustainability goals, regulatory pressures or regional supply chain disruptions due to global crises.

c) Strategic Implications: Discuss how these drivers influence broader supply chain strategy and collaboration.

Real-world examples or industry cases must be used to support your arguments. As requested in CNMSCI573, you are not allowed to select organizations that have been discussed extensively in CNMSCI573, e.g. Toyota, Ford Motors, etc. You are encouraged to reflect on variations across different sectors or regions where appropriate.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

The use of generative AI tools (for example ChatGPT, Grammarly Premium, or similar software) for drafting, editing, paraphrasing, idea generation, or translation is strictly prohibited.

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You must sign the declaration on the cover page to confirm compliance.

GENERAL GUIDELINES

Formatting Requirements

- You must incorporate the EAP402 Coursework Essay Cover Page at the beginning of your essay (see page 4)
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- Insert page numbers at the bottom of each page.
- You should use Times New Roman or Arial font in either 11-point or 12-point size.
- Use 1.5 or double line spacing.
- The essay must be written in continuous academic prose without subheadings or bullet points.

Figures and Tables

- The inclusion of figures and/or tables is optional for this essay.
- Each figure and table should be clearly numbered and titled and must be explicitly mentioned within the paragraph (i.e. not just appear).
- Do not reproduce any figures or tables; only use them if you have adapted them and synthesised different elements.

Citation and Referencing

- Use Lancaster University Harvard referencing system as detailed on the CNEAP402 Moodle page.
- Every citation must have a corresponding reference and vice versa.
- Use summarising and paraphrasing effectively. Direct quotations should not exceed 10% of the total word count.
- You must cite a minimum of 5 high-quality academic sources in English, of which at least 3 should be peer-reviewed journal articles. Professional industry reports, white papers, or government publications may supplement journal sources but cannot replace them.

You must annotate three of your academic sources. For each selected source:

- Highlight or underline key points
- Write brief notes in the margins
- Include the annotated pages at the end of your submission

These annotated pages are not included in the word count.

Do Not (×)

- Use any bullet points
- Write paragraphs that are underdeveloped. A paragraph generally consists of 5–8 sentences that explore a topic with supporting evidence.
- Submit a report. This task must be written as a properly structured academic essay

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Draft Submission: Week 6 (by 23:59 on the date to be confirmed)
- Submit your essay as a Word document via the EAP 402 Moodle page. Submissions cannot be accepted via WeChat or email, and PDF files are not allowed.
- Final submission: Week 8 (by 23:59 on the date to be confirmed). The name of your file should be: 'Coursework Essay Final' - *your student number* - *your name in Pinyin*'

- Your submission must have the EAP402 Coursework Essay Cover Page at the beginning of your document, showing your Chinese name, English name, student number, class number, date and declaration.

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- 10% deduction: More than 36 hours late

  Note: Only medical exemptions with a valid doctor's note will be accepted.

CNEAP402 WRITING DESCRIPTORS

% Grade	Task Response	Coherence and cohesion	Language Lexical resource	Grammatical range and accuracy	Academic conventions
100%	Fully addresses all parts of the task. Presents highly relevant, fully developed, and well-supported ideas. Sources are skillfully synthesised and clearly integrated into the discussion.	Writing is highly coherent and cohesive. Ideas are logically organised, with clear progression throughout. The thesis statement paraphrases the title effectively and outlines the main points with clarity. Paragraphs are focused and well-developed, using effective topic sentences. A wide range of cohesive devices are used naturally and accurately. The Reader can follow the argument effortlessly.	Lexical choices are consistently accurate, varied, and well suited to the academic context, showing sensitivity to tone and nuance. Subject-specific terminology is used appropriately and with confidence. Collocations are effective, contributing to clarity and sophistication of expression.	Demonstrates a wide and flexible range of grammatical structures, including accurate and varied use of both simple and complex sentences. Verb tenses, forms, and agreement are consistently correct. Word forms are used accurately and appropriately. Errors are rare and do not affect meaning.	Fully adheres to academic conventions, including accurate and consistent use of the Lancaster Harvard referencing style. In-text citations and reference list entries are correctly formatted. Paraphrasing is skillful and well-integrated, with clear source attribution. Academic register, structure, and presentation are highly effective and well suited to the task. Demonstrates excellent understanding of academic integrity.
90%	Addresses all parts of the task. Presents, extends, and supports main ideas clearly, though there may be occasional over-generalisations or minor lapses in focus. Sources are generally well synthesised and used appropriately.	Writing is coherent and mostly cohesive. Ideas are logically ordered and generally well developed. The thesis statement is relevant and mostly accurate in capturing the title and main points. Paragraphs are mostly focused and transitions are	Uses a generally precise range of academic vocabulary accurately. Lexical choices are appropriate and support meaning well, with some evidence of flexibility and sophistication. Occasional imprecise word choices or collocational slips	Uses a good range of grammatical structures, with mostly accurate control of simple and complex sentence forms. Occasional errors in verb forms, tense, or word formation may occur but do not impede meaning. Sentence variety is evident	Mostly follows academic conventions. Lancaster Harvard citations are largely accurate, with only minor errors in formatting or punctuation. Paraphrasing is generally appropriate, and sources are attributed. Academic style and register

		effective. Cohesive devices are used well, with only minor lapses in clarity or repetition. The text is easy to follow.	may occur, but these do not obscure meaning or weaken the overall clarity of the writing.	and generally well managed.	are mostly suitable. Occasional lapses do not affect overall credibility.
80%	**Combination of elements from 70% and 90% bands**				
70%	Addresses all parts of the task, though some aspects may be covered more fully than others. Main ideas are generally relevant, but development may be uneven, and some points may lack clarity or sufficient support. Some attempt is made to synthesise and apply sources, though integration may be limited.	Writing is generally coherent, though there may be occasional lapses in logical flow or paragraph unity. The thesis statement attempts to paraphrase the title and outline the essay but may be vague or incomplete. Some cohesive devices are used effectively, but others may be repetitive, mechanical, or occasionally inappropriate. Ideas can be followed, but the reading experience is uneven.	Uses a sufficient range of vocabulary to convey meaning, though word choice is sometimes repetitive, imprecise, or awkward. There is an attempt to use academic vocabulary, but this is occasionally inaccurate or inappropriately applied. Lexical limitations may reduce clarity or force reliance on vague or general terms; meaning remains broadly understandable.	Uses a mix of simple and some complex sentence structures. Errors in grammar, verb forms, or word forms are noticeable but do not seriously hinder understanding. Attempts at variety are made, though sentence structure may be repetitive or occasionally awkward.	Adheres to academic conventions inconsistently. There may be errors or omissions in citation and referencing, including format issues with Lancaster Harvard style. Paraphrasing may be too close to the original or inconsistently attributed. Register is generally appropriate but may slip at times.
60%	**Combination of elements from 50% and 70% bands**				

50%	Addresses the task only partially. A position is presented, but development is unclear or inconsistent. Some main ideas are present, but they may be underdeveloped, repetitive, or only loosely related to the task. Source use is limited, and connections to the argument are often unclear or ineffective.	Coherence is limited. Ideas may be loosely organised, with weak paragraph structure or unclear progression. The thesis statement may be unclear or not well linked to the essay title. Cohesive devices are used inconsistently, and there may be overuse or underuse of linkers and reference words. The reader has to work to follow the arguments.	Vocabulary is limited and may rely heavily on everyday or informal language. Attempts to use academic vocabulary are inconsistent and often result in confusion or inappropriateness. Limited lexical range restricts the writer's ability to express complex ideas clearly.	Grammatical range is limited, with frequent reliance on simple sentence structures. Errors in tense, subject-verb agreement, and word or verb forms are common and may sometimes affect clarity. Attempts at complex structures may result in frequent mistakes.	Limited adherence to academic conventions. Referencing in Lancaster Harvard style is frequently inaccurate or incomplete. Paraphrasing may rely heavily on the original wording or lack proper attribution. Informal register or inconsistent structure may reduce academic credibility.
40%	**Combination of elements from 30% and 50% bands**				
30%	Responds to the task in a minimal or tangential way. Some ideas are presented, but they are difficult to identify, poorly developed, or largely irrelevant. Source use is very limited or inaccurate, and the relationship between sources and ideas is unclear.	Writing lacks coherence. Paragraphs are poorly structured or unrelated, and ideas do not follow a logical order. The thesis statement is weak or missing. Few cohesive devices are used, and those that may be incorrect or confusing. The reader struggles to understand how points connect.	Displays a very limited range of vocabulary, with frequent reliance on basic or repetitive language. There are frequent errors in word choice, including misuse of vocabulary. Attempts at academic expression are largely unsuccessful, and meaning is often unclear or obscured.	Very limited control of grammatical structures. Frequent and recurring errors in verb tenses, agreement, and word forms. Writing consists mostly of simple or fragmented sentences. Errors regularly interfere with meaning.	Weak control of academic conventions. Citations are often missing, incorrect, or not formatted in Lancaster Harvard style. Paraphrasing may be ineffective or show signs of patchwriting. Academic register is poorly controlled, with little attention to formal conventions. Concerns about academic integrity may arise. .

40%	**Combination of elements from 10% and 30% bands**				
10%	Does not adequately address the task. No clear position is presented. Ideas are mostly irrelevant, undeveloped, or absent. There is little or no evidence of appropriate source use.	Writing is incoherent and disjointed. There is no clear structure or logical progression. The thesis statement is missing or unrecognisable. Cohesive devices are largely absent or misused, resulting in confusion. The text fails to communicate meaning clearly or logically.	Frequent and severe errors in word choice, form, and usage consistently interfere with communication. Meaning is often unclear, distorted, or lost due to persistent lexical errors. Little to no evidence of control over academic language.	Grammatical control is minimal. Persistent and severe errors in sentence construction, verb usage, and word forms. Complex structures are rarely attempted or consistently incorrect. Meaning is often unclear or lost.	Minimal or no evidence of understanding academic conventions. Lancaster Harvard referencing is absent or wholly inaccurate. Paraphrasing is either not attempted or demonstrates a lack of source understanding. Academic register and structure are inappropriate. Serious concerns about academic integrity are likely.

EAP 402 INDIVIDUAL POSTER PRESENTATION TASK SHEET, Semester 2, 2026

Prepare and deliver an individual poster presentation on your Research Proposal

1. You should give a PowerPoint poster presentation of your research proposal (which was completed as part of your IRP) in Week 16.

2. The presentation should last 6-7 minutes plus time for questions.

3. Your poster presentation should have an initial slide showing your name, ID number and class, a second slide for the poster and final slide for your reference list.

4. The poster slide should contain at least 2 relevant citations, corresponding to the 6 references in the reference list on slide 3.

5. The poster slide should contain between 200-400 words.

6. The poster presentation must have an introduction, main body and conclusion.

7. The PowerPoint slides should contain the following information:

   - *Slide 1: Name, Student ID and Class*
   - *Slide 2: Poster:*

     Introduction

     Literature Review

     Methodology

     Conclusion and Implications
   - *Slide 3: References*

8. A draft PowerPoint Poster presentation should be submitted to Moodle by… (date to be confirmed)

9. The presentation is worth 15% of your final mark for EAP 402 Semester 2.

10. The final submission of your PowerPoint presentation slides should be uploaded to Moodle by the end of Week 15

CNEAP 402 Individual Presentation Descriptors

	Content	Delivery
100% (8.0+)	Fully covers the topic with consistently relevant and thoroughly supported ideas. Exemplary structure with clear and effective signposting throughout. Excellent use of and interaction with visual material, fully integrated into the presentation. Responds to audience questions with confidence, clarity, and insight.	Highly engaging delivery with skillful use of non-verbal communication (e.g. eye contact, gestures, posture). Fluent and consistently audible, with excellent control of volume, pace, and pausing for emphasis. Highly effective use of notes or cue cards, with minimal or no reliance on reading word for word from a script.
90% (7.0)	Covers the topic very well, with mostly relevant and well-supported ideas. Very well-organised structure with effective use of signposting. Strong use of and engagement with visual material. Handles questions clearly and competently.	Mostly engaging delivery with effective non-verbal communication and only minor lapses. Largely fluent and audible, with very good control of volume, pace, and pausing. Competent use of notes or cue cards, with only occasional dependence on reading word for word.
80%	**Combination of elements from 70% and 90% bands**	
70% (6.0)	Covers the topic well with generally relevant main ideas, though some may lack clarity or depth of support. Structure is clear and well organised, with effective signposting in most parts. Good use of visual material with some effective interaction. Responds to questions appropriately, though with occasional hesitation.	Some engaging delivery, though there may be occasional issues with non-verbal communication (e.g. limited eye contact or gesture). Generally fluent and audible, with reasonable control of volume, pace, and pausing. Mostly appropriate use of notes or cue cards, though there may be moments of reliance on reading word for word from a script.
60% (5.5)	Addresses the topic satisfactorily, though ideas may be uneven, underdeveloped, or only partially supported. Structure and signposting are adequate but may lack consistency or clarity. Visual material is used but may not be fully integrated or effectively referenced. Attempts to answer questions, though responses may be limited or lack fluency.	Satisfactory delivery overall, though more noticeable problems with non-verbal communication may affect engagement. Speech is sometimes fluent, but there may be inconsistencies in volume, speed, or pausing, and occasional issues with audibility. Basic use of notes or cue cards, but noticeable reliance on reading from a script may limit natural delivery.
50% (5.0)	Covers the topic only partially or unsatisfactorily, with few relevant ideas, most of which are insufficiently explained or supported. Structure and signposting are unclear or inconsistent. Limited or ineffective use of visual material, with minimal interaction. Attempts to answer questions, but communication issues hinder clarity.	Delivery is unsatisfactory, with significant issues in non-verbal communication (e.g. limited eye contact, minimal gesture, or distracting body language). Fluency is inconsistent, and use of volume, speed, and pausing is limited or ineffective; audibility may be poor at times. Use of notes or cue cards is unsatisfactory, with frequent reliance on word-for-word reading that reduces audience engagement.
40%	**Combination of elements from 50% and 30% bands**	

30% (4.0)	Main ideas are difficult to identify, and content is largely irrelevant or unsupported. Structure and signposting are very limited or poorly executed. Weak or inappropriate use of visual material, with little or no engagement. Struggles significantly to respond to questions, with frequent misunderstandings that affect overall	Delivery is inadequate, with major and persistent problems in non-verbal communication (e.g. lack of eye contact, rigid posture, or distracting gestures). There is little evidence of fluency, and volume, speed, or pausing are rarely used effectively; audibility issues may seriously hinder comprehension. Notes or cue cards are used in a very limited or ineffective way, with heavy and consistent reliance on reading word-for-word from a script.
20%	**Combination of elements from 30% and 10% bands**	
10% (3.0 and 3.0 -)	Covers the topic in a minimal or fragmented way, with ideas that are mostly irrelevant, unsupported, or poorly communicated. Little to no evidence of logical structure or signposting. Visual material is used ineffectively or not at all, with no meaningful interaction. Unable to respond to questions, or responses are confused and unclear, significantly impairing communication.	Very few discernible features of effective delivery are present. Severe problems in non-verbal communication (e.g. no eye contact, monotone delivery, or distracting behaviour) are evident throughout. Speech lacks any fluency, with almost no effective use of volume, pace, or pausing. Large portions may be inaudible or difficult to follow. There is little to no evidence of independent speaking, with total or near-total reliance on reading directly from a full script.
	Presentations under 2 minutes will receive a 5% deduction from the final Semester 1 grade.	

EAP 402: INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO (IRP) GUIDE: GENERAL INFORMATION

Your Independent Research Portfolio is a central part of your studies and something you add to regularly as you develop your language and study skills throughout the course. Your IRP is comprised of two separate booklets:

1) Booklet 1: EAP 402: INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO: Lesson Tasks Booklet
2) Booklet 2: EAP 402: INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO: Self Evaluation and Learning Log Booklet
3) Booklet 3: EAP 402: INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO: Research Proposal Booklet

You will be given advice during the semester on how to complete an assignment in each booklet and when to submit.

BOOKLET 1:

LESSON TASKS (LT) BOOKLET

(Weeks 1-10)

- This part of your IRP is concerned with the work you complete for your classes.
- To ensure you obtain a good IRP score, you should complete the tasks given.
- All lesson tasks should be completed within the Lesson Tasks Booklet.
- Lesson tasks will usually take place every two weeks and will be in-class and mainly off-line.
- Only those students who can provide a doctor's note may request to complete the lesson task at another time. *Each lesson task must be submitted by the end of the class.*

Lesson Task Submissions: Weeks: 2/4/6/8/10

BOOKLET 2:

SELF-EVALUATION AND LEARNING LOG BOOKLET

(Weeks 1-12)

The first piece of work will be a self-evaluation. You should read any relevant/useful chapters of Critical Thinking Skills (2023) during the semester to review areas of interest to you. The self-evaluation will be followed by fortnightly reflections on your learning; they should contain information about your study progress in a more informal way.

BOOKLET 3:

RESEARCH PROPOSAL BOOKLET

(Weeks 7-14)

You should write a research proposal containing the following sections (see Research Proposal Task Sheet for more information):

- SR1: Introduction
- SR 2 Literature Review
- SR 3 Methodology
- SR4 Conclusion and implications

EAP 402 INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO (IRP) MARKING DESCRIPTORS

96-100%: Distinction (Outstanding)

- Demonstrates comprehensive and insightful engagement with all aspects of the portfolio task.
- All components are fully addressed with depth, precision, and originality.
- Content is highly relevant, critically developed, and coherently structured.
- Evidence of independent thinking, synthesis of ideas, and advanced understanding.
- Work exceeds expectations in scope, analytical depth, and clarity of communication.

90-95%: Distinction

- Demonstrates very strong engagement with all aspects of the task.
- Addresses all components thoroughly with substantial development and clear insight.
- Content is highly relevant and well-structured, with strong analytical and critical elements.
- Minor limitations prevent it from reaching the exceptional depth or originality of the highest band.

80-89%: Merit (Very Good)

- Addresses all parts of the portfolio clearly and competently.
- Content is relevant, well-developed, and logically structured.
- Demonstrates good understanding and some critical engagement.
- Shows consistent quality, though analysis and synthesis may lack the depth or originality of higher bands.

70-79%: Strong Pass

- Addresses all required components of the task.
- Content is generally relevant and appropriately developed.
- Demonstrates sound understanding, though analysis may be descriptive rather than critical.
- Structure and coherence are clear but may lack sophistication.

60-69%: Pass (Threshold Standard Achieved)

- All required components are addressed at a satisfactory level.

- Demonstrates adequate understanding of key concepts.
- Content is mostly relevant, though depth and critical engagement are limited.
- Work shows competence but lacks consistent analytical development.

50-59%: Marginal Fail (Below Threshold Standard)

- Some required components are incomplete, underdeveloped, or insufficiently addressed.
- Demonstrates gaps in understanding of key concepts.
- Content may be partially relevant but lacks sufficient development to meet minimum academic standards.
- Fails to meet one or more core learning outcomes.

40–49% Clear Fail

- Significant omissions in addressing the task.
- Limited understanding of key concepts.
- Content lacks development and coherence.
- Fails to meet multiple learning outcomes.

30–39 Serious Fail

- Addresses only small portions of the task.
- Demonstrates weak or incorrect understanding.
- Poor structure and limited relevance.

0–29 Very Serious Fail

- Minimal or no meaningful engagement with the task.
- Content largely irrelevant or inaccurate.
- Does not demonstrate understanding of course material.

ALL IRP lesson tasks must be completed in the booklet which begins with the cover page below. The booklet is entitled: EAP 402: Independent Research Portfolio (IRP)Lesson Tasks Booklet and will be available on Moodle.

'It does not matter how slowly you go as long as you do not stop.'

Confucius.

EAP 402: Independent Research Portfolio (IRP)

Lesson Tasks Booklet

Name:

Student Number:

Class:

Your self-evaluation and fortnightly reflections must be included in the booklet which begins with the cover page and initial pages below. It is entitled:

EAP 402: Independent Research Portfolio (IRP)
Self-evaluation and Learning Log Booklet

This booklet will be available on Moodle.

'Trust in dreams, for in them is hidden the gate to eternity.'
Khalil Gibran

EAP402: INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO (IRP)

Self-Evaluation and Learning Log Booklet

Name:

Student number:

Class:

Critical thinking: Knowledge, skills and attitudes

Self-evaluation

For each of the following statements, rate your responses as outlined below.
Note that 'strongly disagree' carries no score.

4 = 'strongly agree' 3 = 'agree' 2 = 'sort of agree' 1 = 'disagree' 0 = 'strongly disagree'

		Rating 4–0
1	I feel comfortable pointing out potential weaknesses in the work of experts.	
2	I can remain focused on the exact requirements of an activity.	
3	I know the different meanings of the word 'argument' in critical thinking.	
4	I can analyze the structure of an argument.	
5	I can offer criticism without feeling this makes me a bad person.	
6	I know what is meant by a line of reasoning.	
7	I am aware of how my current beliefs might prejudice fair consideration of an issue.	
8	I am patient in identifying the line of reasoning in an argument.	
9	I am good at recognizing the signals used to indicate stages in an argument.	
10	I find it easy to separate key points from other material.	
11	I am very patient in going over the facts in order to reach an accurate view.	
12	I am good at identifying unfair techniques used to persuade readers.	
13	I am good at reading between the lines.	
14	I find it easy to evaluate the evidence to support a point of view.	
15	I usually pay attention to small details.	
16	I find it easy to weigh up different points of view fairly.	
17	If I am not sure about something, I will investigate to find out more.	
18	I can present my own arguments clearly.	
19	I understand how to structure an argument.	
20	I can tell descriptive writing from analytical writing.	
21	I can spot inconsistencies in an argument easily.	
22	I am good at identifying patterns.	
23	I am aware of how my own up-bringing might prejudice fair consideration of an issue.	
24	I know how to evaluate source materials.	
25	I understand why ambiguous language is often used in research papers.	
	Score out of 100	

Interpreting your score

Going through the questionnaire may have raised some questions about what you know or don't know about critical thinking. The lower the score, the more likely you are to need to develop your critical thinking skills. A score over 75 suggests you are very confident about your critical thinking ability. It is worth checking this against objective feedback from your tutors or colleagues. For example, if your score is less than 100, there is still room for improvement! If your score is under 45 and remains so after completing the book, you may find it helpful to speak to an academic counsellor, your tutor or a supervisor to root out the difficulty.

Priorities: Developing critical thinking abilities

- In column A, identify which aspects of critical thinking you want to know more about. Give a rating between 5 and 0, giving 5 for 'very important' and 0 for 'not important at all'.
- In column B, consider how essential it is that you develop this aspect soon. Give a rating between 5 and 0, where 5 is 'very essential' and 0 is 'not essential at all'. Add the scores in columns A and B to gain an idea of where your priorities are likely to lie. Column D directs you where to look for more information on that point.
- Use your findings to set your priorities.

Aspects I want to develop further **I want to:**	**A** **Want to know more?** Rate from 0 to 5 5 = 'very important'	**B** **How essential to develop it now?** Rate from 0 to 5 5 = 'essential'	**C** **Priority score** Add scores for columns A and B	**D** **See Chapter**
1 understand the benefits of critical Thinking				1
2 remain focused on the exact requirements of an activity				2
3 pay better attention to small details				2
4 know what is meant by a 'line of reasoning'				3
5 identify the component parts of an argument for critical thinking				3
6 recognise the words used to signal stages in an argument				3, 10
7 distinguish argument from Disagreement				4
8 distinguish argument from summaries, descriptions and explanations				4
9 pick out the key points from background information				4
10 be able to analyse the structure of an argument				5, 10, 11
11 evaluate whether arguments are internally consistent				5
12 understand what is meant by an intermediate conclusion				5
13 be able to structure an argument				5, 10, 11
14 be better at reading between the lines				6

Aspects I want to develop further **I want to:**	**A** **Want to know more?** Rate from 0 to 5 5 = 'very important'	**B** **How essential to develop it now?** Rate from 0 to 5 5 = 'essential'	**C** **Priority score** Add scores for columns A and B	**D** **See Chapter**
15 recognise underlying assumptions				6
16 recognise when an argument is based on false premises				6
17 recognise implicit arguments				6
18 understand what is meant by denoted and connoted meanings				6
19 be aware of how cause, effect, correlation and coincidence can be confused				7
20 be able to check for 'necessary and sufficient conditions'				7
21 identify unfair techniques used to persuade readers				6, 7
22 recognise tautology				7
23 recognise flawed reasoning				6, 7
24 be able to evaluate source materials				1, 8
25 understand what is meant by authenticity, validity, and reliability				8
26 evaluate when samples are Representative				8
27 understand what is meant by 'triangulation'				8
28 check for levels of probability				8
29 apply critical thinking when making notes				9, 10
30 use language more effectively to structure argument				3, 10, 11
31 present my own arguments clearly in writing/for essays				10, 11
32 apply critical reflection to my study/ Assignments				12
33 apply reflection in my professional life				12, 13
34 apply critical thinking to career/life Planning				12, 13

Priorities for action

- Look back over the priorities table. Identify the three aspects to which you gave the highest scores. If more than three have the highest score, select three to start with.
- Write the three priorities here as actions starting with 'I will …', using words that are meaningful to you – e.g. 'I will find out what tautology means.'

1. I will
2. I will
3. I will

Summary: What is critical thinking?

1 **Critical thinking is a complex process.** It involves many sub-skills and calls for an attitude of mind. It requires an open mind, system, perseverance, accuracy and precision.

2 **Critical thinking is about 'reasoning'.** It involves being able to construct and analyse arguments, based on reason and evidence. That requires decision-making and judgement.

3 **Critical thinking helps us to challenge hidden assumptions.** That includes our own assumptions and biases, as well as those of other people and the sources we use.

4 **Developing critical ability confers many benefits.** These include better problem-solving, less likelihood of being cheated or misled, greater confidence, speed and accuracy in analysing complex information.

5 **It involves emotional self-management and courage**: It can be challenging to question ourselves and others.

6 **Self-awareness supports critical ability.** It is not always easy to detect our own bias, so it is important to be alert to influences on our thinking and decision-making.

7 **Academic study requires criticality.** Students need to be able to critique the work of others, including source materials, experts and peers, in a systematic, even-handed way.

8 **Critical abilities can be obstructed unnecessarily** by barriers such as insufficient focus, strategy or attention to detail, as well as misunderstandings. These can all be tackled.

9 **Identify your strengths and priorities.** Use these to develop your critical abilities.

Adapted from: Cottrell, S. (2023) *Critical thinking skills: Effective analysis, argument and reflection*. 4th Ed. London: Bloomsbury Academic.

WEEKLY REFLECTIONS

You will write fortnightly reflections on your learning. Each of these should be at least 2 paragraphs in length (minimum 250 words in total) to reflect on your English language learning. This process will allow you to understand your strengths and weaknesses, and to improve your writing skills. If you are not sure about what you can include in your reflections, here are some questions to guide you:

- *What have you been doing in your classes? What thoughts and feelings do you have about classes?*
- *What have you been doing at home to improve your English? Were the results positive?*
- *What progress have you made since the previous week or two weeks?*
- *What problems have you encountered in your English learning? How did you solve them?*
- *What are your strengths and weaknesses? How can you use your strengths to the best of your ability? How can you improve your weaknesses?*
- *What are your objectives for next week(s)?*
- *What areas of writing/reading/listening/ do you feel you need to work on?*
- *What can you do to improve in these areas, either inside or outside the classroom?*

**NB Remember that thinking or reflecting on how you learn can improve the learning process.*

EAP 402 RESEARCH PROPOSAL TASK SHEET Semester 2, 2025

Topic

- You are going to write a research proposal on a topic in your own subject area.
- The research proposal is a component of your Independent Research Portfolio.
- You must think of your own topic, your own title and conduct the research yourself.
- This webpage can offer guidance on choosing a topic: https://www.scribbr.com/research-process/dissertation-topic/

General requirements:

- Your Research Proposal should be completed using the booklet provided on Moodle. The Research Proposal must contain the following sections:

  Cover Sheet

  Introduction

  Literature Review

  Methodology

  Conclusion and Implications

  References
- The Research Proposal should be 1,200 - 1,600 words in length, excluding the cover page and reference list.
- Each section should contain information outlined in the Research Proposal booklet.
- You must paraphrase and summarise source material appropriately rather than quoting excessively. A small amount of quoting (no more than 10% of your text) is permitted.
- Plagiarism will be penalised.
- You should have at least 6 references to sources (written or spoken in the English language) in your reference list at the end of your Research Proposal.
- The word count should be included at the end.
- IMPORTANT*: Remember that each reference in your reference list must have a corresponding citation, and vice-versa.
- Please upload your finalized IRP Research Proposal in Week 14 (precise date to be confirmed).
- The name of your file should be: '*IRP: Research Proposal - your student number - your name in Pinyin.*

Formatting requirements:

- 1.5 or 2.0 line spacing
- A space after each full stop and comma
- A page number inserted at the bottom of the page
- The font should be 12-point Roboto or Times New Roman.
- Black font colour

The research proposal must be written using the Research Proposal Booklet indicated. The booklet will be available on Moodle:

Independent Research Portfolio (IRP)

Research Proposal Booklet

Title of Research Proposal

EAP 402

Name:

[Chinese name]

[English name (if any)]

Research Proposal
研究计划

1. TITLE

2. Introduction

200 - 400 words: Try to provide facts and references here in order to give relevance to your study and why it is being conducted. This will help to explain the motivation behind your research and how important it is for academia, the industry or public sector it is being conducted in.

A. Begin with background information to give the context of your proposed research; explain any core concepts and/or terminology so that a non-expert reader may not understand.

B. Based on the context that you have presented, explain a research problem you aim to address.

> *Go to this useful webpage to find out more about defining a research problem:*
> *https://www.scribbr.com/research-process/research-problem/#Step%201:%20Identify%20A%20Broad%20Problem%20Area*

C. Give a rationale for your research and indicate its scope (the scope explains the extent to which the research area will be explored).

Examples of scope:

- *The population or sample that you will be studying*
- *The duration of the research*
- *The topics or theories that you will discuss*
- *The geographical location*

D. Give a general aim for your research and state what value your research will create - who will benefit?

NB* you should briefly refer to key literature in your introduction.

3. Literature Review

600-800 words: This is one of the most important sections of your research proposal. It demonstrates that you know your field, who the key research players are in it, what has been said in the past and what is being said at the moment. You will want to mention — and where appropriate, quote from — key works in your area.

This is the section that requires the most preliminary research, so be sure you spend ample time in an academic library and use search engines for relevant academic papers before presenting. You do not need to discuss every work in your area, but you should present a competent outline. A good way of presenting a literature review coherently is in the form of a narrative, which can either be chronological or thematic.

A. Expand on the key literature mentioned in the introduction.

B. Evaluate (consider strengths and weaknesses of) previous research connected with your research problem.

C. Outline the gap(s) in the literature that you plan to address in your project.

Research Questions and objectives

D. State your research question(s) (or hypotheses) which should relate to the gap in the literature.

E. Give 2 or 3 specific objectives of your proposed research.

Go to this useful webpage to find out more about writing a literature review:
https://www.scribbr.com/methodology/literature-review/

NB*

1. *Hypotheses are stated when the research design is experimental or quasi experimental in nature. Survey research and non-experimental research are generally limited to research questions.*

2. *The research questions and objectives can be stated either at the end of the introduction or after the literature review.*

4. Methodology

200 - 400 words: This is where you explain how and where you plan to carry out your research. To justify the chosen methodology, you may refer to previous studies conducted on your chosen topic.

A. Describe your research design. Will it be qualitative or quantitative? Descriptive, correlational or experimental, etc.?

B. Explain a) how you will select a sample or cases b) the methods you will use to collect and analyse your research data.

C. Outline any:

i. Delimitations. These are the characteristics that limit the scope and describe the boundaries of the study, such as the sample size, age group, gender, geographical location or setting in which the study takes place, etc. Additionally, you may choose to use some research tools and methodologies to collect data but not others.

ii. Limitations: any weakness or deficiency in the proposed research.

D. Are there any ethical considerations?

5. Conclusion and Implications

200 – 300 words:

A. Briefly Summarise why your proposed research is important, and indicate:

i) your research problem and purpose

ii) the methodology

B. Give some implications of your proposed research:

i) *Practical Implications*

Will your findings help improve a process, inform policy, or make a case for concrete change?

ii) *Theoretical Implications*

Will your work help strengthen a theory or model, challenge current assumptions, or create a basis for further research?

6. Proposed Timetable (Optional)

This section is optional, but it could help you to appreciate the scale of your work in the preliminary stages of planning.

Example:

'This research project is expected to take *(number)* months/years. The following timeline is proposed as follows…'

You could use a project schedule table in order to plan out the project as well as give a better understanding as to the breakup of the project timeline. An example of this is:

Week	**1**	**2**	**3**	**Project End**
Date	Jan 1 - Jan 7	Jan 8 - Jan 14	Jan 15 - Jan 21	
Phase 1	Planning			
Phase 2		Research		
Phase 3			Analysis	

PLAGIARISM AND ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

What Is Plagiarism?

Plagiarism is treated very seriously by both BJTU and Lancaster University. It is a form of academic malpractice.

Plagiarism occurs when a student uses another person's work, ideas, words, data, or creative output without appropriate acknowledgement and presents it as their own. This includes material taken from:

- Books and academic journals
- Websites and online sources
- Reports, dissertations, or other student work
- Artificial intelligence tools
- Any other published or unpublished source

If you use ideas or information from any source in your essay, report, or dissertation, you must:

1. **Quote** the original words accurately (using quotation marks), or
2. **Paraphrase** the idea properly in your own words,

and in both cases, you must provide a full and accurate reference so that the reader can locate the original source.

Failure to acknowledge sources correctly — including poor paraphrasing, incomplete referencing, or incorrect citation — may result in an allegation of plagiarism. Penalties may include mark reductions, failure of the assignment, or more serious academic consequences depending on the severity of the case.

Why Plagiarism Happens

The University recognises that plagiarism can occur for different reasons.

Some students may struggle with:

- Developing effective paraphrasing skills
- Understanding how to integrate sources into their writing
- Applying UK academic referencing conventions
- Adjusting to new academic cultures or expectations

However, plagiarism may also occur deliberately. Deliberate plagiarism involves intentionally submitting work that is not your own in order to gain academic advantage. This is considered a serious breach of academic integrity and the core values of the University. All cases, whether arising from misunderstanding or deliberate misconduct, are handled under University regulations.

University Regulations

Plagiarism cases are handled in accordance with Lancaster University's regulations on Academic Malpractice, as outlined in the Manual of Academic Regulations and Procedures (MARP).

The Plagiarism Framework is available at:

https://www.lancaster.ac.uk/academic-standards-and-quality/regulations-policies-and-committees/principles-policies-and-guidelines/plagiarism-framework/

These regulations apply to:

- Undergraduate (UG) programmes
- Postgraduate Taught (PGT) programmes
- Assessed taught components of Postgraduate Research (PGR) programmes

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI)

The use of generative AI tools (for example, ChatGPT or similar systems) may be restricted or prohibited depending on the assessment requirements of your module. Where AI use is not explicitly permitted, submitting AI-generated text as your own work constitutes academic malpractice. Students are responsible for ensuring that all submitted work complies with module-specific academic integrity policies. If you are unsure whether a particular tool is permitted, you must consult your module convenor before using it.

Turnitin and Similarity / AI Detection

All written work submitted via Moodle will be processed through Turnitin.

Turnitin compares your submission against:

- Published academic sources
- Internet content
- Previously submitted student work
- Other relevant databases

Turnitin also provides an AI writing indicator, which estimates the proportion of text that may have been generated by artificial intelligence tools.

It is important to note that:

- Similarity scores and AI indicators do not automatically mean that academic misconduct has occurred.
- These tools provide signals, not proof.
- Academic judgement is always used when reviewing submissions.

If concerns arise regarding plagiarism or inappropriate AI use, the case will be reviewed in accordance with Lancaster University's Academic Malpractice regulations.

How to Avoid Plagiarism

You can avoid plagiarism by:

- Taking careful notes when reading
- Recording full reference details for all sources
- Learning how to paraphrase effectively
- Using Lancaster Harvard referencing correctly
- Allowing sufficient time for drafting and revision

Support is available through:

- Academic writing workshops
- Module teaching sessions
- Library referencing guidance
- Your tutors and academic advisors

Developing good academic practice is an important part of your university education.